



Economics Honors

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 11 · ONE SEMESTER · ½ CREDIT · HONORS

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This overview is drawn from the Florida course description and Optima's 2026–27 course plan rather than a fully built course, so scholars may see some variation in topics, cases, and activities from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

Economics Honors explores how human beings make choices about scarcity, value, and mutual benefit. Rather than treating economics as a neutral science, the course examines the moral dimensions of economic life: questions about justice, stewardship, and human flourishing. Scholars develop conceptual tools for understanding both markets and the limits of market thinking. They work with primary and secondary sources, build and interpret economic models, and reason carefully about how individual decisions and public policies shape prosperity. As an honors course, the texts and tasks are more abstract and demanding throughout, and scholars are expected to apply, analyze, and evaluate complex ideas rather than simply recall them.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Foundations: Scarcity, Choice, and Systems (strand)

Factors of production, opportunity cost, and how traditional, market, command, and mixed systems answer what, how, and for whom to produce.

2 Markets and Firms (strand)

Supply, demand, and equilibrium price; forms of business organization; the four market structures; price and nonprice competition; and how earnings are determined.

3 Money, Banking, and Monetary Policy (strand)

The functions of money and the money supply; credit, savings, and investment services; risk, return, and diversification; and the Federal Reserve's tools.

4 Government, Fiscal Policy, and the Business Cycle (strand)

Fiscal policy and broad economic goals; taxes, deficits, and national debt; inflation and its effects; externalities and regulation; and the phases of the business cycle.

5 The Global Economy and Economic Thought (strand)

Comparative advantage and trade barriers; comparing developed and developing economies; case studies in globalization; and the ideas of major economists and economic theories.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Study of primary and secondary sources most days, with text-based discussion of economic decisions.
- Building and interpreting economic models, graphs, and data.
- Evidence-based writing and reasoning about markets, policy, and trade-offs.
- Immersive VR and AI-supported activities, plus research and presentation tasks, where they fit.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday, for one semester

- Reading, discussion, and writing fill most of the scheduled time.
- Research and project weeks may run a little longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- A notebook for notes, sources, and reasoning.
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for written work.
- Access to Optima's VR campus for immersive activities.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily for the semester it is offered.